# Lutheran West steals victory away from Avon

BOYS BASKETBALL

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

AVON — For 31 minutes Tuesday night, it appeared Avon's basketball team would treat the home fans to something they hadn't seen all year: A win at the Eagles' nest.

But Lutheran West had other ideas and literally stole the game in the final minute, 51-48. The Longhorns won their seventh in 18 outings. Avon, with just one victory — at Brookside earlier this year — lost its 15th.

Avon held the lead nearly the entire night, starting with a 14-2 run right off the bat. The Eagles still led 46-38 on Erich DeChant's drive to the hoop with just 3½ minutes left — but the Longhorns weren't dead.

Lutheran West scored seven unanswered points to close within 46-45 when Avon's sophomore Russ Logan kept the Eagle hopes alive with a pair of free throws with 1:32 left.

Enter John Karls. The 5-foot-11 senior, who scored but eight points the whole night for the Lutherans, drove his way for one basket and rebounded his own missed shot for another to take the lead with 49 seconds left. The Longhorns sealed it with a steal and two free throws by Ryan Helmink with 21.5 left.

"John's done that (before)," said Longhorn boss Joe King. "He's getting more consistent at it. He's had some nice games of late."

DeChant missed a contested 3-pointer from the left baseline and Chad Stencil's last second shot fell off the front of the rim to send LW back home with the victory.

"I would give it to him," said King of the last play designed to go DeChant's way. "Our sophomore Ryan Helmink did a nice job (defensively) and Adam Bok did a real good job on DeChant. Adam's a quick kid, an athletic kid. We just have him lock on to people."

"They did what I wanted them to do for the most part," said Avon coach Matt Dunlap. "We just didn't have a couple things go our way towards the end. We just didn't finish it off."

DeChant led all scorers with 25 points for Avon. Chris Hass and Nick Boriska combined for 27 for the Longhorns.

"We played a lot more like we want to play," said Dunlap, disappointed but not discouraged by the loss. "We did a lot of positive things. I can't be too hard on them because they've been working hard. Even with the record we have, they still come every day and practice hard. We've come a long way even though it doesn't seem to be getting us any wins."

Avon had only a dozen turnovers and 39 rebounds to the Longhorns five and 36 in the same categories.

The Eagles were 17 of 48 from the field, Lutheran West 18 of 58. West had seven three pointers, Avon four. At the line, the Eagles were 10 of 16 to LW's eight of 11.

| Lutheran West | G | F | T | Avon | G | F | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hass | 4 | 3 | 14 | DeChant | 9 | 4 | 25 |
| Boriska | 5 | 0 | 13 | Logan | 1 | 4 | 6 |
| Karls | 4 | 0 | 8 | Mandoke | 2 | 1 | 5 |
| Fogle | 3 | 2 | 8 | Posendek | 1 | 1 | 3 |
| Helmink | 1 | 2 | 5 | Stencil | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Schnitger | 1 | 0 | 2 | Frioud | 3 | 0 | 6 |
| Hackney | 0 | 1 | . | Henry | 1 | 0 | 3 |
| Weber | 0 | 0 | 0 | Schwartz | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Totals | 18 | 8 | 51 | Totals | 17 | 10 | 48 |

Points by quarters

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luth.West | 8 | 15 | 11 | 17 | —51 |
| Avon | 16 | 12 | 8 | 12 | —48 |

**3-point goals:** Lutheran West — Hass 3, Boriska 3, Helmink. Avon — DeChant 3, Henry.
**Junior Varsity:** Lutheran West 49-42 OT.

## BUCKEYES

From B1

He became more upset after the Buckeyes let Bell break behind them for two fast-break layups that put Michigan State up 52-37 early in the second half.

Finally, the cork popped after Michael Redd (18 points) and George Reese (10 points) weren't awarded trips to the foul line after O'Brien thought they were hammered inside.

Peterson hit both ends of the technical to give Michigan State its biggest lead, 54-37, with 14:40 to go.

"The second one, I was just trying to get his (referee Tom O'Neill's) attention," O'Brien said. "I didn't appreciate the fact that he absolutely ignored me, but I'm not happy that I got kicked out of the game."

For a moment, the Buckeyes seemed pumped by O'Brien's dismissal. They outscored Michigan State 14-7 to trim their deficit to 10 (61-51) with 8:43 remaining.

But the Buckeyes' comeback was thwarted, mostly because they were beaten on the boards (43-30) and their bench failed to score a single point while Penn, Redd and Reese rested.

"We just couldn't get over the hump," Penn said. "When we needed a stop, we couldn't get it, and when we needed to make a shot, we couldn't."

"I had to be more aggressive offensively. It's more on me on the road."

Cleaves didn't have to carry the load. And it didn't matter that the Spartans' bench scored only five points.

"I said all week that in games like this, sometimes the stars don't play good," Michigan State coach Tom Izzo said. "We needed an X-factor guy, and I thought Charlie Bell really stepped up and answered the bell."

Bell scored only six points in the team's first meeting. This time, he was 9-of-14 from the floor and made Penn worked hard for every shot.

But it was Cleaves who engineered the victory.

"Cleaves gets everyone else involved," O'Brien said. "He made some shots, especially in transition."

The Buckeyes had a chance to seize momentum before halftime. They trailed just 40-33 and had the ball, but Redd had his pocket picked by Cleaves.

Redd tried taking his crossover dribble between his legs, but Cleaves swiped him clean and dashed down court — then made two free throws after being fouled by Brent Darby with 57 seconds left.

Ohio State, which is second in the conference in turnover margin, threw the ball away three times in the final minute of the half. Bell cashed in on a turnover, hitting a pair of free throws to give Michigan State a 44-33 lead.

### No. 6 Michigan State 83, No. 7 Ohio State 72

**OHIO ST. (17-5)**
Redd 7-18 3-3 18, Reese 5-10 0-0 10, Johnson 2-6 1-1 5, Penn 8-17 9-10 30, Brown 4-6 1-1 9, Darby 0-1 0-1 0, Robinson 0-0 0-0 0, Savovic 0-0 0-0 0, Ocokoljic 0-0 0-0 0, Dudley 0-1 0-2 0. Totals 26-59 14-18 72.
**MICHIGAN ST. (83)**
Peterson 7-18 9-12 26, Granger 0-4 0-0 0, Hutson 2-7 1-5 5, Cleaves 6-10 9-12 24, Bell 9-14 4-4 23, Thomas 0-0 0-0 0, Chappell 1-2 0-0 3, Richardson 0-1 0-0 0, Anagonye 1-1 0-2 2, Ballinger 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 26-57 23-35 83.
**Halftime**—Michigan St. 44, Ohio St. 33. **3-point goals**—Ohio St. 6-17 (Penn 5-10, Redd 1-6, Brown 0-1), Michigan St. 8-20 (Cleaves 3-4, Peterson 3-9, Chappell 1-1, Bell 1-4, Granger 0-2). **Fouled out**—None. **Rebounds**—Ohio St. 30 (Johnson 8), Michigan St. 43 (Peterson 11). **Assists**—Ohio St. 11 (Penn 7), Michigan St. 12 (Cleaves 7). **Total fouls**—Ohio St. 24, Michigan St. 18. **Technical fouls**—Ohio State coach Jim O'Brien 2, Peterson. **A**—14,659.

LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

**STRAIGHT UP:** Avon Lake's Paul Skellinger (51) puts up a jumper Tuesday night against Olmsted Falls.

## FALLS

From B1

Gansey scored nine points in the second period, 15 points in the first half and 22 for the game. He led Falls in rebounds with nine.

But over the course of the evening it might have been Greg Koch who hoisted the Bulldogs on his back. Koch had a career-high 20 points and eight rebounds and led Falls with five assists. He buried nine of 10 free throw attempts.

"If we gave out a player-of-the-game award, he'd probably be it," Donahue said. "This was as well as he's played all year."

Koch's biggest play was likely one that would not show in the statistics. With Falls leading 55-51, Reitler missed the second of his one-and-one at the free throw line. Koch punched the ball out to the perimeter where Williams chased it down. Williams then fired to Andy Jaroscak on the right baseline for a 3-point basket that gave the 'Dogs a seven-point lead with 2:27 left.

"We had five or six possessions in the fourth period that really hurt us," Avon Lake coach Dave Ohlinger said. "We came up with nothing and they built their lead. It's hard to come back against a team like Olmsted Falls from seven or eight points down. You break down against a good team like that and they'll take advantage of it."

Actually, Falls had chances to go farther ahead on the Shoremen, but couldn't take advantage. A foul on Tom Port after Jaroscak's 3-pointer put Gansey on the line, but the front of the one-and-one was missed.

Again, however, the ball was sent backwards and Reitler corralled it. He was fouled immediately but also missed his opportunity at the line. The Bulldogs made 17 of 24 free throw attempts but were 11-of-13 at the line at one time.

Avon Lake snatched the lead for the first time, 28-26 at 1:21 of the second quarter, via six straight points. Koch tied it with two free throws and had a shot at going ahead by halftime, but Paul Neslon picked Gansey's pocket and flipped the ball to Justin Booher, who drove into the lane before feeding Paul Skellinger for a slam dunk with two seconds left.

Falls regained the lead for good when Williams scored off an offensive rebound and tallied again seven seconds later following a steal in the backcourt to make the score 40-38. Gansey's basket with 2:40 to go in the third completed an eight-point run and gave the Bulldogs a 44-38 edge.

Skellinger and Brian Ingelright powered Avon Lake with 24 and 16 points, respectively. The pair had 34 of the Shoremen's 42 points through the first three quarters. Skellinger was also high for the Shoremen with seven rebounds.

Both teams were 50 percent from the field. Olmsted Falls made 24 of 48 field goal tries. Avon Lake connected on 25 of 50.

| Avon Lake | G | F | T | Olmsted Falls | G | F | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ingelright | 6 | 1 | 16 | Koch | 5 | 9 | 20 |
| Guenther | 2 | 0 | 5 | Williams | 2 | 2 | 6 |
| Booher | 2 | 0 | 5 | Reitler | 1 | 2 | 4 |
| Jones | 1 | 0 | 2 | Gansey | 9 | 3 | 22 |
| Skellinger | 11 | 2 | 24 | Holland | 1 | 0 | 2 |
| Port | 3 | 0 | 6 | Schneider | 1 | 0 | 2 |
| Nelson | 0 | 0 | 0 | Jaroscak | 3 | 0 | 7 |
| | | | | Keys | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| | | | | Saluja | 2 | 1 | 5 |
| | | | | Mazzella | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Totals | 25 | 3 | 58 | Totals | 24 | 17 | 68 |

Points by quarters

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Avon Lake | 12 | 18 | 12 | 16 | — 58 |
| Olmsted Falls | 15 | 13 | 18 | 22 | — 68 |

**Three-point goals: Avon Lake** — Ingelright 3, Guenther, Booher; **Olmsted Falls** — Koch, Gansey, Jaroscak.
**Junior varsity:** Avon Lake, 52-42.

BOYS BASKETBALL

# Patriots' offense heats up

## Open Door gets 90 points again

Matthias R. Monschein
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Senior Appreciation Night became a chance for Open Door's seniors to show their talents.

The Patriots rolled their way to their second consecutive 90-plus outing with a 93-61 victory over the First Baptist Sabres on Tuesday.

The Patriots finished the night with four players scoring in double digits. Leading the way for Open Door was senior Josh Smith who totaled 26 points to lead all scorers.

Smith was complimented by the outstanding performance of James Tepple, who scored 17 points, brought down nine rebounds and blocked three shots.

"I loved playing in the game tonight," said Tepple. "I used to play for First Baptist and it was a big game for me to come back and play against some old friends."

"James is just a solid player for us," said Patriot coach Alan Januzzi. "The last three games he has played outstanding defense and he has rebounded the ball James understands the game of basketball and that goes beyond just having the ball."

Everything seemed to favor the Patriots as they jumped out to a 25-18 lead by the end of the first quarter. Matt Green turned up the heat on the Sabres by scoring 12 second-quarter points on his way to a 24-point night.

The lead soon ballooned to 51-30 at the half.

"I was not pleased with our defensive effort tonight. It really hurt us," said Sabre coach Ray Cox. "They did not stop the penetration from the Open Door team. You have to give them credit because they took advantage of that way too often."

The second half score increased in the Patriot's favor as they held First Baptist's scoring to only 11 points in the third compared to their own 22 points.

"I think the team is just where they want to be as we head into the tournaments," said Januzzi. "The key for us is to instill confidence in each one of those players and I think that over the past few games we can do that."

| First Baptist | G | F | P | Open Door | G | F | P |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bowman | 5 | 0 | 12 | Smith | 11 | 2 | 26 |
| Arnold | 2 | 0 | 4 | Green | 11 | 2 | 24 |
| Young | 4 | 0 | 9 | Davis | 10 | 1 | 21 |
| Lake | 5 | 0 | 15 | Tepple | 7 | 2 | 17 |
| Anderson | 6 | 3 | 15 | Reiley | 1 | 3 | 5 |
| Kritz | 3 | 0 | 6 | Woods | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Mandalone | 0 | 0 | 0 | Fortner | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Anderson | 0 | 0 | 0 | Alaska | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| | | | | Fletcher | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| | | | | Freeman | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| | | | | Cambell | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| | | | | Scholmier | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Totals | 25 | 3 | 61 | Totals | 40 | 10 | 93 |

Score by Quarters

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| First Baptist | 18 | 12 | 11 | 20 | — 63 |
| Open Door | 25 | 26 | 22 | 20 | — 93 |

**3-point goals:** First Baptist — Lake 5, Bowman 2, Young; Open Door — Smith 2, Tepple.
**Junior varsity:** Not played.

## CAVS

From B1

coach Randy Wittman said. "He missed one or two shots and could have easily let that affect him, but he didn't."

Murray scored 14 of his points in the second half, when the Cavs outscored the Spurs 49-35.

"Sometimes you start off slow and sometimes you start off hot," he said. "It's how you finish that counts."

That Murray finished strong against the team he almost signed with didn't seem to have any special meaning to him, even though the player the Spurs eventually signed, Samaki Walker, didn't play a minute against the Cavs.

"You don't want to get up for just one game," Murray said. "You have to get up for all the games."

The Cavs also got 20 points, seven rebounds and three assists off the bench from point guard Andre Miller — Brevin Knight went 1-of-6 from the field in his return to the starting lineup after a three-game absence — and 14 points from Shawn Kemp. Wesley Person had 13 points in his fifth straight start for the injured Bob Sura (sprained big toe).

Twin towers Tim Duncan and David Robinson combined for 41 points for San Antonio, but neither was particularly effective.

Duncan had 21 points, five rebounds, eight turnovers and didn't get his first rebound until eight minutes remained in the third quarter, while Robinson had 20 points and 11 boards before fouling out. The Towers combined to go 16-of-37 from the field, with many of their shots not even coming close.

No other Spurs starter had more than six points and no one off the bench had more than nine.

"It was the worst exhibition of effort and basketball that I have seen all season long by any team," San Antonio coach Gregg Popovich said. "I don't know what else to tell you. To break it down more than that doesn't make any sense to me. It was a very poor exhibition."

Evidently, Popovich took out his frustration on a chalkboard in the visitors' locker room.

"He went a little wild, but it's all good," Duncan said. "It happens. We needed to hear that from him."

Wittman, on the other hand, was very happy after watching the Spurs shoot 38.7 percent from the field (29-of-75). San Antonio was 13-of-42 in the second half (.310).

"That's as good of an effort as we've had all year," Wittman said. "My hat's off to our players. ... We were focused every possession defensively. That's the way we need to play every night.

"This has to be a springboard for these guys to understand that they've got to be focused every night. Not just against San Antonio. Not just against Portland. You've got to be focused every night."

### Cavs 92, Spurs 81

**SAN ANTONIO (81):** Kersey 2-6 2-2 6, Duncan 8-20 5-7 21, Robinson 8-17 4-6 20, Johnson 1-7 4-4 6, Elie 2-5 0-0 4, Rose 1-3 2-2 4, Daniels 0-0 0-0 0, Porter 3-7 1-2 9, Jackson 3-6 0-0 8, Kerr 1-4 0-0 3. Totals 29-75 18-23 81.
**CLEVELAND (92):** Murray 10-21 6-6 27, Kemp 5-12 4-5 14, Bryant 2-7 3-4 7, Knight 1-6 1-2 3, Person 4-11 3-4 13, Miller 8-15 3-3 20, DeClercq 1-4 0-2 2, Ferry 3-5 0-0 6, Chilcutt 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 34-81 20-24 92.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| San Antonio | 22 | 24 | 15 | 20 | — 81 |
| Cleveland | 21 | 22 | 27 | 22 | — 92 |

**3-Point Goals**—San Antonio 5-11 (Porter 2-4, Jackson 2-5, Kerr 1-2), Cleveland 4-9 (Person 2-4, Miller 1-1, Murray 1-4). **Fouled out**—Robinson. **Rebounds**—San Antonio 46 (Robinson 11), Cleveland 56 (Murray 12).

## PANTHERS

From B1

gave EC a two-man advantage for 1:27, because the Pirates' Pat Willse was already in the penalty box for roughing.

They took advantage of it when John Porostosky scored from eight feet at 2:28 with an assist from Basinger.

Unfortunately, it was the only time the Panthers could capitalize on a power play. They had five more chances, but the Pirates' penalty killers wouldn't cave.

The wheels started to come off for EC when River's John Manzatt scored at 12:59 of the second period. Ben Camper followed with his second goal of the night at 11:34 and, 33 seconds later, Blake Fredrickson scored still another.

No one knew it at the time, but the Pirates already had enough goals to win.

The Panthers trailed 5-1 when they put on their big third-period push. It paid off when Bill Falk scored an unassisted goal at 7:51 and Jim Hartman, with an assist from Nick Wakefield, came back with another just 42 seconds later.

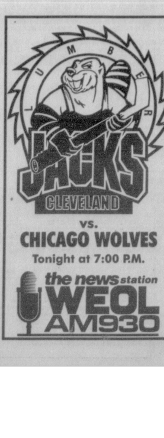
At 1:57, Phiel pulled goalie Andrew Zink — in for Jason Stone in a time-saving substitution late in the game — and the Pirates got the back-breaker at 1:25 when Manzatt shot the puck into EC's empty net.

"I was proud of the guys the way they came back in the third period," Phiel said. "We had our chances. Our best goal scorers had good opportunities to score, but their goalie came up big. He shut us down, especially in close on some of the rebounds."

Score by Periods

| | 1 | 2 | 3 | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Elyria Catholic | 1 | 0 | 2 — | 3 |
| Rocky River | 1 | 3 | 2 — | 6 |

First Period
**Goals** — 1, Rocky River, Ben Camper (unassisted), 9:07; 2, Elyria Catholic, John Porostosky (B.J. Basinger) pp, 2:28. **Penalties** — Rocky River, Pat Willse (roughing) 2:07; Rocky River, R.J. Christyson (cross-checking) 3:33; Elyria Catholic — Porostosky (slashing) 2:11.
Second Period
**Goals** — 3, Rocky River, John Manzatt (Matt O'Connor) pp, 12:59; 4, Rocky River, Camper (Manzatt, Mark Ebner), 11:34; 5, Rocky River, Blake Fredrickson (Kyle Bacon), 11:01. **Penalties** — Elyria Catholic, Porostosky (high-sticking) 13:15; Rocky River, Matt Gresko (hooking) 10:07; Rocky River, Christyson (interference), 1:56.
Third Period
**Goals** — 6, Rocky River, Dave Biscardi (Brian Groh), 12:46; 7, Elyria Catholic, Bill Falk (unassisted), 7:51; 8, Elyria Catholic, Jim Hartman (Nick Wakefield), 7:19; 9, Rocky River, Manzatt (Camper), 1:25. **Penalties** — Elyria Catholic, Kevin Baxter (tripping) 11:43; Rocky River, Fredrickson (high-sticking) 9:52.
**Shots-On-Goal:** Elyria Catholic 11-9-11—31; Rocky River 11-12-13—36. **Goalie Saves:** Elyria Catholic — Jason Stone 28, Andrew Zink 2; Rocky River — Chris Bansci 28.




# Grafton's Deak set for district

Paul Heyse
The Chronicle-Telegram

Slight in size but not in ability, Magnificat junior diver Katie Deak of Grafton will be letting things rip Thursday evening as she battles for a state berth at the Northeast Ohio District Swimming and Diving meet at Cleveland State University.

Actually, the 5-foot-2, 110-pound Deak wants to create as little rip as possible, so to speak. A clean entry into the water is critical to a good score.

Last year, Deak finished fifth in the district meet en route to a 10th place finish in the state tournament. She had been sidelined until three weeks before sectionals because of a broken arm suffered cheerleading for St. Edward.

"I'm having a much better season. I have a lot more degree of difficulty in my dives," Deak said. "For example, I added a back 1½ with 1½ twist. It's got a degree of difficulty of 2.5. Only a couple of divers in the area have dives with a degree of difficulty that is higher."

**DISTRICT DIVING**
**WHEN:** Thursday; Division II girls, 9 a.m.; Division I boys, 2 p.m; Division I girls, 5 p.m.
**WHERE:** Cleveland State University

One of those — Wadsworth senior Susan Over, the 1999 state runner-up — is the favorite in the Division I. Deak is one of the top contenders for the runner-up spot.

The top eight Division I girls, top eight Division I boys and top seven Division II girls will advance to the Division I state diving competition, which is set for Feb. 24.

A total of 11 dives will make or break the season for the divers. Deak is confident she is up to the challeznge after winning her second straight sectional title on Feb. 11 at Solon High School.

"I just have to concentrate and focus on getting the consistency with my dives," Deak said. "Basically, it's whoever is the most consistent will win."

Deak was first at CSU Invitational and second at Canton Invitational this season.

Berea senior Chris Jones leads area boys' hopes. Ninth in the state last year, Jones won the Division I boys title at Solon.